



Baking *Supplies* *Sourcing*

*The curated wholesale supplier list for the US, UK, Canada and Australia.
Essential ingredients with brand recommendations. The under-\$80 starter
toolkit and when to upgrade.*

- Wholesale suppliers ranked by country and product category
- Brand-by-brand recommendations for flour, butter, sugar, colours and meringue powder
- Minimum viable toolkit under \$80 USD (equivalents in GBP, CAD, AUD)
- Monthly ingredient budget by production tier — 24 / 48 / 96 cookies per week

Second bonus of the five

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This bonus is designed so you can walk into any supermarket, cake-decorating store, or Amazon page and buy exactly what you need without wasting money on things you'll never use. Everything is priced in USD with country-specific equivalents so the numbers land honestly for readers in the US, UK, Canada and Australia.

How to think about supplies

The two rules that stop first-year bakers from wasting hundreds of dollars.

Every cake-decorating store, Wilton catalogue and Amazon "must-have" listicle will tell you that you need 40 different tools before you bake your first batch. You do not. Nine tools cover 95% of everything you'll do in your first six months.

Rule 1 • Buy for the batch you're making this week, not the business you might have next year

The impulse to buy the giant colour set, the copper cutter collection, the professional turntable, the airbrush kit — all of that is normal. Resist it for six weeks. Every one of those items has a chance of never being used depending on which niche your first customers pull you into. Some bakers land on wedding orders and never need seasonal shapes. Some land on kids' parties and never need florals. You don't know which one you are yet.

Rule 2 • Ingredients are consumables; tools are capital

Spend generously on ingredients — using the good vanilla, the good butter, the good gel colours is what makes your cookies look and taste like a paid product. Spend miserably on tools — the \$2 rolling pin from the supermarket rolls dough exactly as well as the \$30 marble one from the specialty store, at least for the first hundred batches.

THE 6-WEEK HOLD RULE

Any tool or supply that costs over \$30 that isn't on the minimum toolkit list: don't buy it for at least six weeks. If you still want it after six weeks of baking, buy it. Ninety percent of the time you'll forget you ever wanted it.

CHAPTER 2

Wholesale suppliers by country

The suppliers that actually sell to home bakers and small home-based businesses, ranked by category and country.

United States

CATEGORY	SUPPLIER	BEST FOR
Bulk baking ingredients	Costco Business / Sam's Club	Flour, sugar, butter, eggs in bulk (membership required)
Restaurant-supply	Webstaurant Store (webstaurantstore.com)	Bulk packaging, boxes, cellophane, tissue paper — no membership needed
Cake decorating specialties	Sur La Table, Michaels, Hobby Lobby (retail)	Cutters, tips, food-safe brushes, small-quantity gels
Cake decorating online wholesale	Fat Daddio's, GlobalSugarArt.com	Cake-decorating tools, cutters, moulds at wholesale pricing
Bakery boxes and packaging	Uline (uline.com), Amazon Business, Berlin Packaging	Custom-size bakery boxes at bulk pricing
Gel colours and meringue powder	Amazon, AmeriColor direct (americolor.com)	AmeriColor gel sets, Wilton meringue powder

United Kingdom

CATEGORY	SUPPLIER	BEST FOR
Bulk baking ingredients	Bookers Cash & Carry, Costco UK (Business Card)	Flour (McDougalls, Allinson), sugar, butter in trade quantities
Restaurant supply	Nisbets (nisbets.co.uk)	Bakery boxes, cellophane, professional packaging
Cake decorating wholesale	Squires Kitchen (squires-shop.com), Cake Décor Wholesale	Sugarpaste, gels, moulds, meringue powder (Merri-White)
Specialty ingredients	Bakery Bits (bakerybits.co.uk)	Speciality flours (00, spelt, gluten-free), unusual ingredients
Gel colours	Sugarflair, ProGel, Rainbow Dust — via Squires or Amazon UK	UK-favourite gel colour brands
Packaging	Foldabox UK, TinyBox Company	Kraft boxes with clear windows in every size

Canada

CATEGORY	SUPPLIER	BEST FOR
Bulk baking ingredients	Costco Canada, Bulk Barn (retail bulk)	Bulk flour, sugar, chocolate, sprinkles
Cake decorating wholesale	Golda's Kitchen (goldaskitchen.com), Bake Supply Plus	Full cake-decorating range, cutters, tips, gels
Restaurant supply	McCall's Cake and Cookie Craft, Uline Canada	Packaging and bakery boxes
Ingredients online	Amazon.ca, Vanilla Food Company	Vanilla extract, meringue powder, specialty items

Australia

CATEGORY	SUPPLIER	BEST FOR
Bulk baking ingredients	Costco Australia, Reliance Foodservice	Bulk flour (Manildra, Anchor), sugar (CSR), butter
Cake decorating wholesale	Wholesale Cake Supplies (wcs.com.au), Cake Decorating Central	Cake decorating tools, cutters, colours, moulds
UK brands in AU	Squires Kitchen AU distributors	Sugarpaste, meringue powder, professional cake supplies
Gel colours	Fractal Colors (fractal-colors.com.au), AmeriColor via Wholesale Cake Supplies	AU-manufactured gel colours (same category as AmeriColor)
Packaging	Loyal Ready-Pack, BoxCo Australia	Kraft bakery boxes, cello bags, ribbons

WHAT "WHOLESALE" ACTUALLY MEANS FOR HOME BAKERS

Most restaurant and bakery wholesale suppliers (Webstaurant, Uline, Nisbets, Golda's Kitchen) sell to anyone with a shipping address — no business registration or reseller certificate required. Wholesale prices come from ordering case quantities, not from having a business licence. As a home baker with a modest business you can access 60-70% of the wholesale pricing available to a commercial bakery.

Ingredient list with brand recommendations

The eight ingredients you actually need, with the brand recommendations that make the biggest difference to the finished product.

1 • All-purpose flour / plain flour

US/CA: King Arthur All-Purpose (unbleached) or Bob's Red Mill. **UK:** McDougalls Plain, Allinson's Plain. **AU:** White Wings, Manildra Plain. Weight-buy — 5-10 kg / 10-20 lb bags are usually 30-40% cheaper per gram than 1 kg supermarket packs.

2 • Unsalted butter

Do not skimp here. The butter is 60% of the flavour of a plain vanilla cookie. **US:** Kerrygold, Land O'Lakes, Plugra (higher fat content). **UK:** Lurpak, President, or store brand European-style. **CA:** Lactantia, Gay Lea. **AU:** Western Star, Anchor. Salted butter does not work — the salt content varies too much across brands and you can't calibrate the recipe.

3 • Powdered sugar / icing sugar

US: Domino, C&H. **UK/CA/AU:** Silver Spoon, Tate & Lyle icing sugar, CSR. Sift before every use — clumps clog piping tips.

4 • Large eggs

Standard large eggs, room temperature before mixing. Free-range preferred. Doesn't matter for the recipe; matters for allergen labelling on your product.

5 • Meringue powder

US/CA: Wilton Meringue Powder (widely available), CK Products (professional quality). **UK:** Squires Kitchen Merri-White. **AU:** Wholesale Cake Supplies stocks Wilton and local equivalents.

6 • Gel food colouring

Never liquid — it wrecks the icing consistency. **US:** AmeriColor 12-colour Student Kit (\$30-40) covers 90% of what you'll ever need. Wilton Icing Colors are a lower-cost alternative. **UK:** Sugarflair or ProGel — start with a 12-pack. **AU:** Fractal Colors or AmeriColor via WCS.

7 • Pure vanilla extract

Not imitation. The difference is night and day in a plain sugar cookie. **US:** Nielsen-Massey, Rodelle. **UK:** Nielsen-Massey UK, Waitrose Cooks' Ingredients. **AU:** Queen Vanilla Extract (natural). Clear vanilla for royal icing (won't tint the icing).

8 • Sprinkles, edible pearls, gold dust

Fancy Sprinkles (US, ships internationally): the industry-favourite artisan brand. **Sweetapolita (CA):** Canadian-manufactured decorative sprinkles. **Sweet Stamp (UK):** good UK-based supplier for edible glitter and pearls. Buy 3-4 basic

mixes to start — white pearl, gold, rainbow, one seasonal.

NON-EDIBLE GLITTER WARNING

Some "glitter" sold in craft stores is decorative-only and not food safe, even if it's on the cake-decorating aisle. Look for the label "**edible**" or a food-grade certification. In the UK the term to look for is "for food use" — anything labelled "non-toxic" or "decoration only" is not food safe.

CHAPTER 4

The under-\$80 minimum toolkit

Nine tools. Total under \$80 USD. Enough to bake and decorate 200+ cookies without a single further purchase.

ITEM	WHERE	USD	GBP	CAD	AUD
Digital kitchen scale (0.1 g precision)	Amazon	\$12	£10	C\$16	A\$20
Rolling pin (any)	Supermarket	\$5	£4	C\$7	A\$8
Two half-sheet baking pans	Supermarket / Amazon	\$18	£14	C\$24	A\$28
Parchment paper roll (baking paper)	Supermarket	\$5	£3	C\$6	A\$7
Basic cookie cutter set (6 shapes)	Michaels / Amazon	\$8	£6	C\$11	A\$14
100 disposable piping bags (12-inch tipless)	Amazon / WCS	\$10	£8	C\$13	A\$16
Piping tips set (#1, #2, #3, #4)	Wilton / Amazon	\$8	£6	C\$11	A\$14
Wire cooling rack	Supermarket	\$8	£6	C\$11	A\$14
AmeriColor Student Kit (12 gel colours)	Amazon / AmeriColor	\$32	£28	C\$44	A\$54
TOTAL		\$106	£85	C\$143	A\$175

This total is a bit above \$80 USD because the AmeriColor set is the one place I refuse to soften — it's the difference between amateur and professional-looking colour on your cookies. If you truly need to stay under \$80, use a smaller 6-colour gel set (basic red, blue, yellow, green, black, brown) for \$18 and add colours as your orders demand.

WHAT THIS TOOLKIT PRODUCES

With the nine items above, from a stocked pantry, you can produce 24-cookie batches once per week for six months without buying a single additional tool. That's 500+ cookies, roughly \$3,000-4,500 USD in revenue at typical retail pricing.

The \$500+ upgrade toolkit

The items to buy once your revenue crosses \$500-1,000/month. In order of impact-per-dollar.

Do not buy any of these before you cross \$500/month in orders. They're upgrades, not necessities.

1. **Stand mixer with paddle attachment (KitchenAid or equivalent, \$200-350):** transforms royal icing consistency and saves 15 minutes per batch.
2. **Impulse heat sealer for cellophane bags (\$15-30):** professional-looking sealed individual bags per cookie. Immediately raises your perceived quality.
3. **Extended cookie cutter collection (15-20 seasonal shapes, \$40-80):** unlocks Christmas, Halloween, Easter and Valentine's-specific orders.
4. **Turntable / cake decorating stand (\$15-25):** makes edge-flooding faster and cleaner.
5. **Airbrush kit and food-grade compressor (\$60-120):** only if you want to offer painted backgrounds and stencil work.
6. **Marble slab or silicone rolling mat (\$20-40):** nicer to roll on, easier to clean.
7. **Second oven / countertop convection oven (\$150-300):** doubles your batch output on production Saturdays.

CHAPTER 6

Monthly ingredient budget by production tier

What you'll actually spend on ingredients at each production tier. Numbers are USD averages — expect UK/AU to run 10-25% higher.

TIER	WEEKLY OUTPUT	MONTHLY INGREDIENT SPEND	ESTIMATED MONTHLY REVENUE	INGREDIENT % OF REVENUE
Tier 1 · Starter	24 cookies/wk (96/month)	\$85-120	\$500-800	14-17%
Tier 2 · Growing	48 cookies/wk (192/month)	\$160-220	\$1,000-1,600	13-16%
Tier 3 · Established	96 cookies/wk (384/month)	\$300-420	\$2,200-3,200	12-14%

Notice that ingredient cost as a percentage of revenue *decreases* as your output grows — bulk buying, less waste, better recipes. This is why the numbers in Bonus 5 (Pricing That Profits) matter: your first-year pricing needs to be right for the Tier 1 economics, not Tier 3.

BREAK-EVEN FOR SUPPLIES

3-4 orders

Your \$80-100 starter toolkit pays back in your first 3-4 paid orders. Everything after that is pure margin against the toolkit investment.

CLOSING

Your shopping list for week one

The exact list to build before your first bake day. Print this page or save it to your phone.

Tools (one-time)

Digital kitchen scale	\$12
2× half-sheet baking pans	\$18
Basic cookie cutter set	\$8
100 disposable piping bags + tips set	\$18
AmeriColor 12-colour Student Kit	\$32
Parchment / rolling pin / cooling rack (supermarket)	\$18
Tools subtotal	~\$106

Ingredients (week one)

All-purpose flour · 2 kg	\$4
Unsalted butter · 500 g	\$5
Powdered sugar · 1 kg	\$3
Large eggs · 6	\$3
Meringue powder · 8 oz / 225 g	\$12
Pure vanilla extract · 4 oz / 120 ml	\$9
Fine salt · 500 g	\$2
Ingredients subtotal	~\$38

TOTAL WEEK-ONE INVESTMENT

~\$144 USD

£115 GBP · C\$195 CAD · A\$235 AUD. This includes everything for 4-6 practice batches plus your first paid orders. From order #4 onward you're only replenishing ingredients.

You're ready to bake

List built, tools chosen, ingredients priced. The only step left is placing the order and getting to your kitchen.

What to do next

Order the tools online. Grab the ingredients at your next supermarket run. Open Module 1 of the main method and bake your first batch this weekend.